Secure the Spec

A campaign for the next 150 years of independent student journalism at Columbia—and beyond.

1877—2027

The Columbia Spectator.

Columbia Spectator.

COLUMBIA SPECTATOR

Columbia  Spectator

Columbia DAILY FOUNDED 1877 Spectator

COLUMBIA DAILY SPECTATOR
FOUNDED 1877

COLUMBIA DAILY SPECTATOR
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COLUMBIA DAILY SPECTATOR

Founded in 1877, the *Columbia Daily Spectator* has trained generations of award-winning journalists.

They learn the craft by producing tough, independent reporting on the university—and they go on to publish work of lasting impact at America's most powerful news organizations. *Spectator* staffers have led *The New York Times, The Washington Post,* network news divisions, and other essential outlets; they have written critically acclaimed books; they have won at least 16 Pulitzer Prizes, as well as Oscars and Emmys and MacArthur Fellowships.

***Spec* is celebrating its 150th anniversary at a moment of strength.** Recognized twice in recent years as the best student newspaper in America, *Spec* has a competitive staff of more than 360 students. They publish continuously online, along with weekly print editions, a magazine, podcasts, a video studio, software products, and an events business. As Columbia's recent crises have proved, *Spectator* is the essential publication for recording campus history, informing the public, and keeping leadership accountable.

But this success comes at a dangerous and urgent moment. *Spec* has almost the smallest endowment among Ivy League newspapers. Its revenue streams are threatened at the same time that ominous trends in technology, government, and the law are converging—and making independent journalism more important than ever.

If we want another 150 years of *Spectator,* this is the moment to act. It is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity to leverage our strength and guarantee the future of student journalism at Columbia for generations to come.

We will raise $1.5 million to accomplish two goals: to fortify *Spectator* and invest in its people. Strengthening the endowment will guard against emerging threats. Enhancing the financial aid program will ensure that every student, regardless of their economic background, can learn journalism at *Spectator.* A new prize will incentivize powerful reporting. And new stipends will help more students find jobs as working journalists—a program you won't find at any other college newspaper.

This is transformational change of the best kind. It helps *Spectator* do more of what it already accomplishes so well.

Your contributions will have a direct impact on *Spectator*'s journalistic backbone and launch hundreds of students into this vital profession. Read on to learn how you can meaningfully support this campaign—and begin the next century and a half of the *Columbia Daily Spectator.*



ALSO: Lionmania photo supplement in the centerfold, and more coverage of the Lion victory on the back page.

COLUMBIA DAILY SPECTATOR

FOUNDED 1877

VOL. CXII—No. 155 NEW YORK, N.Y., MONDAY, OCT. 10, 1988 Copyright 1988 Spectator Publishing Co. FIFTEEN CENTS

WE WIN!

Victory ends 44-game dry spell for CU

By Roger Rubin

IT'S OVER!

For once, fate bought a ticket on the Columbia side. For once, the field goal fell short for the other guys. For once, the score was called back for the other guys. For once, Columbia won.

Princeton placekicker Chris Lutz' 48-yard field goal attempt with but two seconds remaining fell some 15 yards short and the game clock showed nothing but zeros—the scoreboard read Columbia 16

Students take to streets in victory bash

By Joshua C. Gillette

By the looks of things—with toilet paper streaming from the trees of 114th Street, bottle rockets screaming out of fraternity house windows, and the Baker Field goalposts being passed over the heads of throngs of screaming students—you would have thought Columbia had won a football game or something.

We did.

The victory caught half of the campus unaware and the other half—

A Note for Supporters New to Our Cause

If you don't know *Spectator* firsthand—or didn't attend Columbia at all—why should you care about a college newspaper? Because the return on investment is remarkable. Funding journalistic training creates impact for decades, and *Spectator* is one of the field's premiere incubators of talent.

Our alumni have won Pulitzer Prizes for:



- Forcing reform in Washington's group homes for the intellectually disabled
- Advocating for Ground Zero workers neglected after 9/11
- Exposing Harvey Weinstein and igniting the #MeToo movement
- Uncovering sexual assault at USC, leading to a $1 billion settlement
- Examining government failures in Chicago that led to dozens of deaths
- Uncovering Donald Trump's hush-money payments to women

Plus many more—in criticism and photography, from local to international coverage. Whether your philanthropic goal is to support small communities, strengthen democracy, or simply invest in people who make a difference, a gift to *Spectator* provides benefits in the present and beyond.

"That's how I chose Columbia; I followed the ink. I reported for duty at the *Spectator* a full week before the start of classes, an order of priority that remained immutable for four fateful years."



MAX FRANKEL
Editor-in-chief, *Columbia Daily Spectator*, 1952
Executive editor, *The New York Times*, 1986–1994

Introducing the *Columbia Spectator*'s 150th Anniversary Capital Campaign

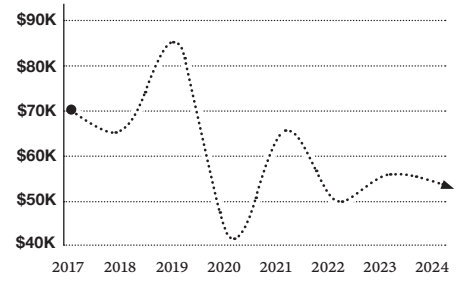
A $1.5 million project to ensure independent journalism thrives at Columbia—and beyond.

GOAL 1

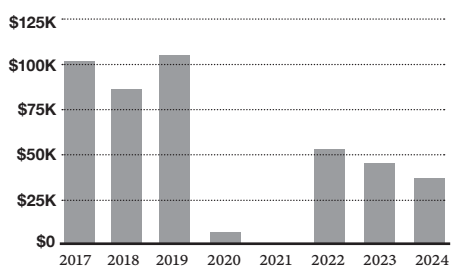
Secure the Future

Spectator's financial position is fragile.

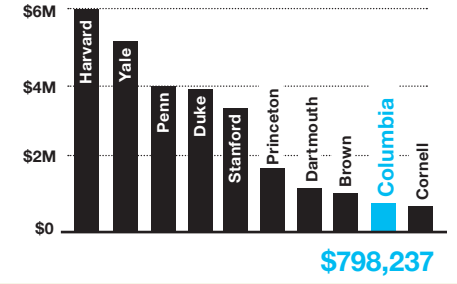
Digital revenue is uncertain.



Print income is on a path to zero.



The endowment is nearly the smallest among top college newspapers.



$798,237

And serious threats are emerging.

- First Amendment protections are weakening in the courts.
- AI is dramatically changing the way people get the news.
- The government is taking a more hostile posture toward journalists.

The conclusion is urgent: *Spectator* is not adequately prepared for the future.

WHAT WE CAN DO:

We will add $800,000 to *Spectator*'s endowment. Doubling our corpus will produce enough passive income to backstop more than half of the operating budget—in perpetuity. That stability will let *Spectator* plan boldly, protect its independence, and thrive even in worsening economic conditions.

GOAL 2

Invest in Our People

Spectator makes great journalists—and great journalists love giving back to *Spectator*.

A new suite of programs will amplify this cycle of excellence.

WHAT WE CAN DO:

Attract the best students, from the widest backgrounds… *Spec*'s financial aid program will grow by $250,000, so that all students, regardless of need, can learn journalism in our newsroom. Over 25 years, these funds will help more than 600 aspiring journalists get their start.

… So that they can create the strongest journalism on campus…

Endowed by $100,000, a new prize will grant $4,000 every year to an outstanding student reporter—half in the fall, and half in the spring, to encourage continued in-depth coverage.

… Then launch into their first jobs…

A new stipend pool of $325,000 will help graduating students afford entry-level media positions. These fellowships, at $5,000 per year, can be the difference between a career that starts and one that doesn't. No other college newspaper offers this.

… And return to campus to develop the next generation of *Spec* talent.

A new speaker series, endowed at $25,000, will bring working journalists to campus for informal lunches with students every quarter.

Image attribution: **Frankel** courtesy of the family.

Why I'm Supporting the *Spectator*

"Journalism—including student journalism—is under incredible pressure. *Spec* continues to serve the Columbia community so well in these particularly challenging times. **I am proud to support the place where I learned so much about journalistic ethics, excellence, and teamwork—and ensure it can continue on for generations to come.** Please join me."

—Sara Just '88 • Senior executive producer, PBS NewsHour

"*Spectator* is where I learned so many important lessons in writing, journalism, and good citizenship. Since my time, ***Spec* has gotten even better, with work-study programs that ensure opportunity for all.** Now, in trying times for journalism in America and around the world, *Spec* needs help to secure its future. I'm proud to support its next 150 years."

—Robert Kolker '91 • Author of *Lost Girls* and *Hidden Valley Road*

"*Spec* journalists have jobs that make mine look easy. Reporting with little or no pay, on your own community, while juggling schoolwork—it's no joke. Thank you to these journalists, and **let's do whatever we can to help them on their quest**."

—Jodi Kantor '96 • Investigative reporter, *The New York Times*

"As a former work-study kid, **I'm proud to support this campaign to make sure all students have the chance to join *Spectator*** and build the next generation of great journalists."

—Kirsten Danis '92 • Investigations editor, *The New York Times*

"**Working at *Spectator* foreshadowed a lifetime in journalism**—the immediate anxiety and delayed satisfaction that comes from holding powerful interests to account, and the adrenaline high of bringing fresh understanding to the community. (Plus the thrill of simply getting something published at all.)"

—Marcus Brauchli '83 • Former executive editor, *The Washington Post*

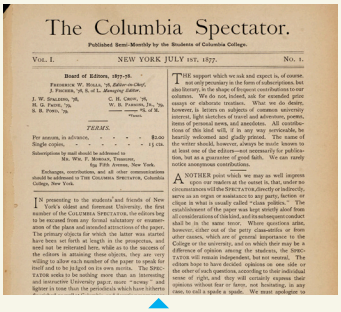
"I learned a lot of wonderful things at Columbia, but nothing topped editing a daily paper during the 1968 student strike. ***Spectator* launched me on a career in journalism that's still going strong almost 60 years later.**"

—Robert Friedman '68 • Senior editor for investigations, *Bloomberg News*

"At 150 years and counting, **the *Spectator*'s archive is an unparalleled resource for anyone seeking to understand how this university rose, faltered, and reinvented itself — and may yet have to do so again**. It is imperative we act to preserve this publication."

—Robert McCaughey • Historian and author of *Stand, Columbia*

150 Years of *Spectator* ...


The Columbia Spectator.

Published Semi-Monthly by the Students of Columbia College.

VOL. I. NEW YORK JULY 1ST, 1877. No. 1.

Board of Editors, 1877-78.

TERMS.

THE support which we ask and expect is, of course, not only pecuniary in the form of subscriptions, but also literary, in the shape of frequent contributions to our columns. We do not, indeed, ask for extended prize essays or elaborate treatises. What we do desire, however, is letters on subjects of common university interest, light sketches of travel and adventure, poetic items of personal news, and anecdotes. All contributions of this kind will, if in any way serviceable, be heartily welcomed and gladly printed. The name of the writer should, however, always be made known to at least one of the editors—not necessarily for publication, but as a guarantee of good faith. We can rarely notice anonymous contributions.

ANOTHER point which we may as well impress upon our readers at the outset is, that, under no circumstances will the SPECTATOR, directly or indirectly, serve as an organ or medium to any party, faction, or clique in what is usually called "class politics."


Columbia Daily Spectator

VOL. LVII (TEN YEARS NO. 3) NEW YORK, WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 13, 1933 PRICE FIVE CENTS

Wolman Says Unions Fail To Advance

Annual Cello Services For Informal Singin...

1000 Battle Police in Anti-Luther Protest; Ambassador Assails Critics of Hitler Regime

Placards Surround Anti-Nazi Speaker

Lieber Bond Chairman Admits that Company Groups Are Cowing In Strength—Mentions Unions' Error

Alumni Fete Football Squad

Butler, Hawkes, Elliott, Donovan Address Group At Club Banquet

Envoy in His Address Calls Nazi Opponents 'Reactionary'—Asserts German Government 'Democratic'—Defends Dictatorship

Girl Arrested, Is Later Dismissed as Clothes Break Out in Street Rally – Parade Follows Demonstration—Crowd Assembles Early

Lions to Face Cathedral Five

Request Forum Be Abolished

Varsity Continues Sesh Third Consecutive Win With New Lineup

Representatives Suggest Surrender or Revision of Croup's Charter


COLUMBIA DAILY SPECTATOR

FOUNDED 1877

Vol. CXII, No. 107 NEW YORK, N.Y., TUESDAY, APRIL 30, 1968 FIVE CENTS

University Calls in 1,000 Police to End Demonstration As Nearly 700 Are Arrested and 100 Injured; Violent Solution Follows Failure of Negotiations

Low Library

1877
Founded as a twice-monthly publication

1902
Spec becomes a daily newspaper

1933

1962
Financial independence from Columbia

1968

1877 1887 1897 1907 1917 1927 1937 1947

You saw their byline in the *Spec* first.


1922
Langston Hughes
poet


ROLLING STONE

1936
Ralph J. Gleason
cofounder of *Rolling Stone*


PBS

1950
Larry Grossman
president of PBS

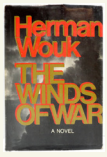
1952
Richard Wald
president of NBC

1960
R.W. Apple
correspondent for the Times


1963
Michael Mukasey
U.S. attorney general


1912
Alfred A. Knopf
publisher


1920
Bennett Cerf
cofounder of Random House



1934
Herman Wouk
novelist


1940
Jack Kerouac
novelist


1952
Max Frankel
executive editor of *The New York Times*


1957
Bernard Nussbaum
White House counsel

1963
David Denby
film critic for *The New Yorker*


1976
Tony Kushner
playwright

... And *Spectator* Today

Named the Best Student Newspaper in America by the Society of Professional Journalists.

360 students on staff: 280 in journalism, 80 in business and technology.

More than 400 students apply to join each fall.

Comprehensive training— reporting, editing, and ethics for journalists; coding, ad sales, and marketing for business staff.

Reporters cover both Columbia and the city.

More than 100 students benefit from *Spec*'s work-study program annually.

Online: 70 articles per week, across news, opinion, sports, and culture. More than 1.3 million Instagram impressions per month.

In print: weekly editions, plus ***The Eye* magazine** and **special supplements.**

Plus: software products, a thriving events business, and much more.

Image attribution: **Cerf** from New York Public Library archives. **Hughes** by Carl Van Vechten. **Kerouac** by Palumbo. **Nussbaum** by The National Archives. **Mukasey** by Justin Hoch. **Kushner** by Commonwealth Club, Ed Ritger. **Genachowski** public domain. **Brauchli** by Miller Center of Public Affairs. **Waxman** from Wikimedia Commons. **Gorsuch** public domain. **Willimon** Peabody Awards. **Moore, Barkan, Weiss, Reyes, Edmondson,** all courtesy of the subjects.









1983

1988

1998 columbia spectator.com goes online

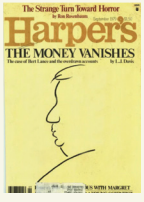
2004 A new format: broadsheet and color. The *Eye* magazine debuts

2014 Shift to digital-first publishing

2024

2027 150th anniversary celebration

1957 1967 1977 1987 1997 2007 2017 2027



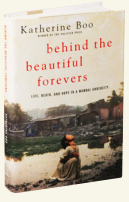
1979
John R. MacArthur
publisher of *Harper's*



1983
Marcus Brauchli
executive editor of *The Washington Post*



1985
Sara Just
executive producer of *PBS NewsHour*



1987
Katherine Boo
author



1997
Beau Willimon
screenwriter



2006
Ady Barkan
activist



2015
Cecilia Reyes
investigative journalist

1976
Lucy Sante
writer



1982
Julius Genachowski
FCC chairman



1984
Sharon Waxman
founder of TheWrap



1985
Neil Gorsuch
Supreme Court justice



1996
Jodi Kantor
investigative reporter for the *Times*



2003
Graham Moore
screenwriter



2007
Bari Weiss
editor-in-chief, CBS News



2018
Catie Edmondson
reporter for the *Times*

Spec talent gets scooped up by:

The New York Times
HBO
AP
THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.
PBS
nyrb
The Washington Post
PBS NEWSHOUR
The Athletic
The Guardian
THE NEW YORKER
THE TRACE
POLITICO
NEW YORK
BUSINESS INSIDER
Bloomberg
NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC
Chalkbeat

16 Pulitzers (and counting)



Immediately met—still needed!

Early donors exceeded our original $1m target out of the gate. Major gifts will help us reach —or surpass —our new $1.5m goal.

Leadership Gifts

✔ = pledges made

Our most dedicated alumni—joined by others who understand the value of creating more journalists—will provide the foundation for the campaign's success.

Flagship gifts are inspiring. They give the campaign credibility and momentum. They allow us to approach the wider community with confidence that we will exceed our target.

✔ $200,000				
✔ $100,000	✔ $100,000			
✔ $50,000	✔ $50,000	✔ $50,000		
✔ $25,000	✔ $25,000	✔ $25,000	...and five more!	...and 11 more!
✔ $10,000	✔ $10,000	✔ $10,000	✔ $10,000	✔ $10,000

Donor Opportunities

More generous gifts bring an opportunity to name a program or fellowship in your honor or someone's memory.

Pool contributions with members of your managing board or graduating year to create a lasting tribute to your era.

$500,000

Endow the cost of *Spectator*'s print products. You can ensure students continue to learn the skills of print journalism—collecting and displaying their best work for maximum impact—regardless of the medium's costs. All editions will recognize your contribution in the masthead.

$200,000

Name the professional fellows program. We expect that this stipend will benefit three students each year. Over the course of the program, you'll help as many as 75 journalists begin their career.

$100,000

Name a new prize for outstanding reporting. Friends and colleagues have come together to honor Stuart Karle '82, *Spectator*'s 105th editor-in-chief and longtime board member.

$50,000

Sponsor five beneficiaries of the financial aid program. You'll receive personalized notes from each year's crop of students, with details about the work you're making possible.

$25,000

Sponsor a new speaker series. You'll make it possible for as many as 100 top journalists to visit campus and meet intimately with *Spectator*'s staff.



"Coming from a low income background, the fact that I could get paid for the work I put into Spec meant I was able to devote more time and energy to my reporting, rather than some other campus job. I'm not sure that I would've been able to take on the added responsibilities of a managing board position without this opportunity. I'm very grateful."
—Jillian Prunty '26



"Finding work-study jobs on campus is already stressful. When I learned about financial aid at *Spec*, I was relieved. This program allows me to fully immerse myself in reporting—work that I'm passionate about."
—Nadia Knoblauch '28

Campaign Timeline

→ **Spring 2025:** Discussion phase. *Spectator*'s trustees consider the merits of a campaign. → **S**
→ **Winter 2025 into 2026:** Quiet phase. Leadership gift solicitation. → **Fall 2026: Public phase.**

"As the unrest at Columbia University became the biggest and most contentious news story in America, the *Columbia Daily Spectator* was pacing the national media—aggressively covering every development with an unmatched level of access to the student body, faculty, and administrators." —*New York* Magazine, May 2024



Your Contribution

We hope you agree that it is vital to support *Spectator* on its 150th anniversary. These essential investments and programs will ensure the organization thrives for generations to come.

To create powerful momentum and make this campaign a success, we ask you to consider a contribution at a level that is meaningful to you.

Amplify Your Gift

Donors can give more substantially by making a multi-year pledge. Joining with classmates and colleagues is another way to leverage your generosity.

	Pledge	Term	Annual Payment	Monthly Payment
Individual	$10,000	5 years	$2,000	$167
Group of 10	$10,000	5 years	$200 per person	$17 per person
Individual	$25,000	5 years	$5,000	$417
Group of 10	$25,000	5 years	$500 per person	$42 per person

Ways to Give

Gifts of cash—by check, wire transfer, or credit card—are the most effective way to support *Spectator,* especially with multi-year pledges.

Giving stock or other securities can be a tax-efficient option. In most cases, you can avoid capital gains tax on an asset that has appreciated and receive a charitable deduction based on the value on the date of the gift.

Give a Qualified Charitable Distribution. You may be able to direct your IRA's Required Minimum Distribution (RMD) to *Spectator* and reduce your taxable income.

Matching gift programs are offered by many employers.

Planned giving—such as a bequest—is an enduring way to honor your legacy. Most gifts of this type would fall outside the scope of this campaign; contact us to discuss.

"A major gift to *Spectator* has major impact—on students, whose lives you'll transform; on the university, which you'll keep accountable; on all of society, which needs strong journalists now more than ever."

—Nick Summers '05, *campaign chair*

Summer 2025: Research phase. Interviews with alumni and peer institutions; data collection.
The entire *Spectator* community joins the campaign. ➔ **Spring 2027:** Celebration.

COLUMBIA DAILY SPECTATOR

Founded 1877 • Independent Since 1962

150th Anniversary Capital Campaign Pledge Form

Thank you.
Your gift strengthens independent student journalism at Columbia and supports the next generation of reporters.

Give online now!

DONOR

Name: _____

Address: _____

Address 2: _____

City: _____ State: _____ ZIP:_____

Phone: _____

Email: _____

Signature: _____ **Date:**_____

RECOGNITION

☐ Use the name above

☐ Use this name instead: _____

☐ This gift is in honor or ☐ in memory of: _____

☐ Keep my gift anonymous

GIFT

I/we pledge to give this total amount: $ _____

☐ One-time payment

☐ Spread my payment over ☐ 1 year ☐ 3 years ☐ 5 years,
and bill me ☐ monthly ☐ quarterly ☐ annually

(see reverse for payment options)

PAYMENT

☐ Check

Payable to: Spectator Publishing Co.

Mail to: 490 Riverside Drive, Room 414, New York NY 10027

☐ Credit card or bank transfer

Enter details at https://secure.qgiv.com/for/columbiadailyspectator/

☐ Wire transfer

Please contact us at giving@columbiaspectator.com for routing and account numbers.

☐ Donor-advised fund

Donee: Spectator Publishing Company, EIN 13-1975005

☐ Stock gift

Please contact us at giving@columbiaspectator.com for instructions.

MATCHING

☐ Contact me to arrange a matching gift

Spectator Publishing Company is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization.

For questions or special instructions, contact giving@columbiaspectator.com.

Give online now!

specpublishing.com/donate

COLUMBIA SPECTATOR

Board of Directors

MEGAN GREENWELL (CHAIR) is the author of *Bad Company: Private Equity and the Death of the American Dream.* She was most recently the editor of *Wired.com* and the interim editor-in-chief of *WIRED.* In previous roles, she was editor-in-chief of Deadspin and worked at *Esquire, New York* Magazine's *The Cut, ESPN the Magazine*, and *The Washington Post.*

ERNEST BROD is the founder of Brod Global Intelligence and vice chairman of Forward Risk. A pioneer and luminary in the corporate intelligence industry, he has more than three decades' experience in applying forensic techniques to corporate investigations and business intelligence engagements in over 100 countries for leading law firms, corporations and financial institutions around the world.

BEN COTTON is general manager of news at *The New York Times,* overseeing product development work in close partnership with the newsroom, after several years as head of subscription growth. He previously worked as a consultant at McKinsey & Co.

GAUTAM HANS is a clinical professor of law at Cornell and the founding director of its Civil Rights and Civil Liberties Clinic. An expert on speech, privacy, civil liberties, and technology policy, he has served in leadership roles in the national clinical legal community, including as co-president of the Clinical Legal Education Association. He serves on the board of editors for the Clinical Law Review.

BETH KNOBEL, PhD., is a professor of journalism at Fordham University. During a 20-year career as a journalist, she was Moscow Bureau Chief for CBS News, among other roles at the network, where she continues to appear as a commentator on news related to Russia, Ukraine, and the former Soviet states.

SARA JUST is the senior executive producer of PBS NewsHour Productions and a WETA senior vice president. She oversees the nightly PBS News Hour broadcast, digital platforms, breaking and special news broadcasts, the PBS News Weekend program, and the weekly public affairs program Washington Week.

STUART KARLE is a partner and general counsel of North Base Media. He was previously the chief operating officer of Reuters News, and for many years was the general counsel of *The Wall Street Journal* and the principal lawyer for news at Dow Jones & Co. He is also an adjunct professor teaching media law at Columbia University Graduate School of Journalism.

NEKESA MUMBI MOODY was most recently co-editor-in-chief of *The Hollywood Reporter.* Previously, she spent 22 years at the Associated Press, including eight as global entertainment and lifestyles editor.

MICHAEL OUIMETTE is chief investment officer at the American Journalism Project. He previously held senior roles at VICE Media. He serves on the board of *The LA Local, Tulsa Flyer, Free Press Indiana, Signal Ohio*, and *The Beacon.*

JOY RESMOVITS is senior editor for local impact at *The Trace.* Previously, she worked as a reporter and editor at *HuffPost, The Los Angeles Times,* and *The Seattle Times.* She serves on the board of the Education Writers Association.

NICK SUMMERS is a senior editor at *The Atlantic.* He has worked as a features editor at *New York* Magazine; as the Sunday Business editor at *The New York Times;* and as a writer and editor at *Bloomberg Businessweek* in New York and London.

STEVEN WALDMAN is a journalist, entrepreneur, digital content pioneer, media executive and nationally known advocate for local news. He is the cofounder and president of Rebuild Local News; the cofounder of Report for America; and the founder of Beliefnet.com. From 2009-2011, he was senior advisor to the chairman of the FCC.

***Spectator* is a 501(c)3 nonprofit. It is financially independent from Columbia University. The EIN is 13-1975005, and Form 990s are available online.**